# AskAI cheat sheet

Twelve commands cover a working day. askai with no command is askai next. Everything else is askai help more or askai help all.

## How AskAI fits together

Run AskAI in a terminal for local checks and file generation. Opening an AskAI skill or slash command in an AI chat uses model tokens. askai go launches an AI tool; that session uses the tool's model allowance.

AskAI stores local session state under .ai-work/ and excludes it through .git/info/exclude. Project guidance remains in the repository. Cursor must open the initialized project as its workspace root to find .cursor/commands/askai-cli.md.

## The loop

| Phase | Sequence |
|---|---|
| Once per machine | askai install then askai check --fix then askai infra. Retry only failed items with askai install --retry |
| Once per project | askai init or askai project refresh, then askai project hide-local, then askai check |
| Each task | askai next, askai prompt, askai go <tool> "task", askai run -- <command>, askai errors, then askai diff |
| Taking a break | askai break, complete the draft with askai handoff "next step", then askai clear when it says safe |
| Coming back | askai resume --copy then askai next |
| Weekly | askai savings --week, askai check, askai mcp, then askai plugins |

## I want to... run...

| I want to | Run |
|---|---|
| See what to do | askai next |
| Turn an idea into a task | askai prompt "idea" --copy |
| Start Cursor, Claude Code, Codex, or Antigravity | askai go <tool> "task" --tier chore\|build\|lead |
| Keep a noisy build or test | askai run -- <command> |
| Read the failure | askai errors |
| Leave the session | askai break |
| Finish the note | askai handoff "next step" |
| Come back | askai resume --copy |
| See spend | askai savings |
| See whether a tool is worth it | askai plugins |
| Turn MCP servers off | askai mcp off <name> |
| Fix what AskAI can fix | askai check --fix |

## The twelve

| Command | Use when | Form |
|---|---|---|
| askai next | you are not sure what to do | askai next |
| askai go | start the coding app on a task | askai go <tool> "task" |
| askai prompt | turn a rough idea into a task | askai prompt "idea" |
| askai run | a build or test prints too much | askai run -- <command> |
| askai check | just installed, or something feels off | askai check |
| askai break | you are stepping away | askai break |
| askai resume | you are back from a break | askai resume |
| askai handoff | finish the note for the next session | askai handoff ["next step"] |
| askai savings | cost feels high | askai savings |
| askai project | this folder needs its pack | askai project <sub> |
| askai install | set up or finish this machine | askai install |
| askai help | you need the exact command | askai help [command] |

Global flags, on any command: --yes --dry-run --json --project. A command shows at most four of its own flags. The rest are askai help <command> --advanced.

## When you need one more

| Command | Use when |
|---|---|
| askai errors | the last build failed |
| askai diff | you want the change list |
| askai clear | the chat is long (over 60%) |
| askai snapshot | save work without a commit |
| askai weigh | a file may be too big to read |
| askai route | you want the tier, not a launch |
| askai models | the model or effort looks wrong |
| askai mcp | too many tool servers are on |
| askai plugins | deciding whether a tool is worth keeping |
| askai convert | a PDF or Office file should be text |
| askai update | AskAI itself is old |
| askai tools | an installed tool is old |
| askai why | one finding needs the reason |
| askai stop | an agent CLI is still running |

## Complete command index

The commands below are also implemented. This table plus the twelve and the additional commands above covers every name in askai help --list. Use askai help <command> --advanced for less common flags.

| Command | Purpose | Form |
|---|---|---|
| askai cli | Prepare a project from the chat folder, then open an AskAI-only terminal. AI review is opt-in. | askai cli [--prepare] [--launch] [--review] [--path DIR] [--about TEXT] |
| askai status | Status in four environment columns, or one selected environment. | askai status [codex\|antigravity\|cursor\|claude] [--host HOST] [--json] |
| askai setup | Short check after install: which hosts are present, check counts, and whether the file validator passed. | askai setup [dir] [--yes] |
| askai bootstrap | Show a personal devcontainer setup; --repo writes a post-create script into this project. | askai bootstrap [dir] [--profile P] [--repo] |
| askai ask | Offline answers on etiquette and the research: the rule, why, the command in each tool, and what AskAI automates. | askai ask <words> |
| askai start | Start a task: ledger entry with tool, task, branch and last commit. | askai start --tool T --task "..." [--repo DIR] |
| askai session | The per-repo ledger in .ai-work/: entries, handoff, measurements, report. askai start, askai break and askai resume are the daily names for those three actions. | askai session init\|pause\|status\|finish\|measure\|report [--repo DIR] [...] |
| askai scaffold | Write the files every agent reads: AGENTS.md, CLAUDE.md, docs/ai/PROJECT_PROFILE.md, .cursorignore, .ai-work/. Never overwrites. | askai scaffold [dir] [--dry-run] |
| askai suggest | Recommend a profile from the files in a folder. | askai suggest [dir] |
| askai profiles | What each profile installs. | askai profiles |
| askai set | Select a project for this terminal or set a persistent fallback. | askai set project NAME \| project --clear \| default NAME \| default --clear |
| askai shell | Enable terminal-scoped project selection in a shell. | askai shell init powershell\|bash\|zsh \| install SHELL --path PROFILE \| uninstall |
| askai tips | The cheat sheet, offline, per tool. peak says whether Claude is in peak hours now. | askai tips [claude\|codex\|agy\|cursor\|session\|habits\|peak] |
| askai test | Run the safe commands one by one, print a short status, and write one capture file. | askai test [--out FILE] [--json] [--real] [--notty] [--compare FILE] |
| askai statusline | Claude Code's status line command (reads the session JSON on stdin): model, context, cache; records snapshots for askai savings. | askai statusline [--demo] |
| askai restore | List backup timestamps, or restore supported configuration files from one backup. | askai restore [stamp] [--dry-run] [--yes] |

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| askai uninstall | Remove only what AskAI added: keys still holding AskAI's value, its marked blocks, its own files and registrations. | askai uninstall [--only ID,ID] [--dry-run] |
| askai version | Print the AskAI version. | askai version |
| askai init | Scan eligible first-party source files, consult detected frameworks' official docs, write a compact project knowledge pack and register its path. | askai init [dir] [--name NAME] [--path DIR] [--about "..."] [--type T] [--yes] [--refresh] [--offline] [--dry-run] [--build "cmd"] [--test "cmd"] |
| askai review | Show which project inputs changed since host AI review; record completion after review. | askai review [status\|done] [--project NAME] [--json] [--all] |
| askai map | Regenerate docs/ai/PROJECT_MAP.md from README folder descriptions and conventional names; preserve purposes you edited. | askai map [dir] [--dry-run] [--diff] |
| askai audit | The seven-point token audit: memory files, tools and proxies, model and effort, hooks, subagents, scheduled work, cache reuse. | askai audit [dir] [--tool claude\|codex\|cursor\|agy] [--project name\|dir] [--json] |
| askai infra | Tools and repository files. | askai infra [dir] [--json] |
| askai guide | The etiquette for each moment of work, offline. | askai guide [install\|start\|work\|break\|resume\|clear\|compact\|cache\|models\|subagen |
| askai docs | Find AskAI documents or check generated command documentation for drift. | askai docs [install\|architecture\|projects\|guide\|cheatsheet\|changelog\|preview\|cont [--print] |
| askai context | What to do at this context level: continue, hand off, clear. 60% is a warning, not an order to compact. | askai context <percent> \| --used N --window M |
| askai todo | Remaining setup and project-review steps: sign-ins, restarts, app settings, model IDs, one-time plugin steps, and repository facts that need confirmation. Checkable items clear themselves. | askai todo [dir] [--all] \| askai todo done <id> \| askai todo undo <id> |
| askai graph | Print the Mermaid architecture diagram from docs/ai/ARCHITECTURE.md and open it in the browser when the terminal is interactive. | askai graph [dir] |
| askai chat | Where to paste a short standing instruction in Claude chat, ChatGPT, and Gemini, and how the four coding apps are set up instead. | askai chat [claude\|chatgpt\|gemini\|code] [--copy] |
| askai direction | Print the one-screen working loop and the most useful command choices. | askai direction |

Legacy spellings continue, etiquette, checkpoint, work, peak, projects, and cheat still route to their current commands. Prefer resume, guide, session pause, guide work, tips peak, project list, and direction in new scripts.

## Which command, when

| You are | Next command |
|---|---|
| Not sure | askai next |
| About to edit | askai go <tool> "task" |

| | |
|---|---|
| About to build or test | askai run -- <command> |
| Over 60% context | askai handoff "next step" then askai clear |
| Stepping away | askai break |
| Back | askai resume |
| Looking at cost | askai savings |
| Something feels off | askai check |

## Inside each coding app

| Purpose | Claude Code | Codex | Antigravity | Cursor |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| What fills the context | /context | /status | /context | /context |
| Usage | /usage | /usage daily | /usage | Dashboard, Usage |
| New task | /clear | /new | /clear | /new |
| Keep a long chat | /compact keep: goal, files, test | /compact | new chat plus a handoff | /summarize |
| Plan before editing | /plan | /plan | /plan | /plan |

Exit the coding app with its own /exit. That returns you to the terminal. exit at the askai> prompt leaves the AskAI terminal.

Local files AskAI writes stay out of git through .git/info/exclude (askai project hide-local). AskAI does not edit a tracked .gitignore.

Optional tools (RTK, Context Mode, Headroom, Graphify, Context7, Repomix) install only with askai install --add ID. RTK, Headroom, and Context Mode cost more in the measured studies. Do not add them to save tokens.